# Dealshape: brief for an outside review (v2)

Lina Mockeliunaite · 20 October 2026, evening · a working prototype built with AI as the build partner. All companies, people, products and deals in it are fictional. This updates the morning brief; the earlier feedback has been acted on (section 3).

**What I'm asking you for:**

1. **Does it land now?** Look at the landing page and both sample deals (sections 5 and 6). Within 10 seconds, can a first-time viewer say what's being delivered, what needs attention and why, what's been agreed, and which documents were checked? Where does that fail?
2. **Stress-test the new claims:** "Catch deal surprises before you sign", and "Two vendors' catalogues, one pipeline".
3. **Rank the remaining weaknesses.** Which three changes would most improve credibility with a COO or Head of Services? Which of those are product changes, and which are evidence I still need to gather?
4. **Point out anything on screen that overstates trust.**

Be direct, and lead with the weakest point. Please don't repeat the known limitations in section 8 unless you think I've understated one.

## 1. The product in 30 seconds

**"Catch deal surprises before you sign."** Dealshape compares what the customer was promised with the contract and the vendor's own product catalogue. It shows which commitments are missing, different or unsupported, with the source evidence. It is for B2B Sales and Delivery teams.

The central insight: *the customer's expectation, the contract and the company's actual offering can describe three different deals.*

Before signing, it shows mismatches while the paperwork can still change. At handover, it locks a read-only record of what Delivery inherits, including anything still open. It is a **visibility tool, not a workflow tool:** no tasks, assignees, approvals or risk scores.

## 2. How it works, and the trust model

1. **Read.** The documents are grouped by deal stage. **The stage comes from the documents** (a signed contract means Signed), never from a click.
2. **Detect (the model).** One model call reads the documents together with **that deal's vendor catalogue**. It proposes each gap with exact quotes and citations.
3. **Verify (code).** Every quote and citation is checked word for word against the supplied documents.
    - A finding that fails a check is not shown. **The screen says how many were held back** ("1 proposed finding couldn't be verified...").

    - The model's own summary carries an "AI-written summary" label.
4. **Recheck (code).** Add an updated document and the check runs again.
    - A gap closes only when the new paperwork shows it no longer holds.
    - The screen names the document that closed it, and which documents were unchanged.
    - A failed check stores nothing.
    - **The model never closes anything.**
5. **Notes are a person's word, not proof.** "Addressed by note" looks different from "Closed by documents", stays in the record, and reopens if the documents change.
6. **Lock the handover record.** It needs two notes (Sales and Delivery) and a signed contract. The record is read-only, carries a fingerprint, and states honestly what is still open.

## 3. What changed since the morning brief

| Feedback | What I did |
|---|---|
| Lead with pre-signature, not "handover" | New tagline, description and audience line; a landing page with "Open a sample deal"; the home page renamed "Deal reviews" |
| Trust language | • "First found in the checked documents" is now computed by code: the earliest exact match, not the document the model happened to quote.<br>• "Quotes checked against the supplied documents".<br>• A check-coverage line.<br>• The lookup of matching contract wording is labelled as a lookup. |
| A second industry | A second vendor with **its own catalogue**: Aivuna (AI support) and Noma Journeys (travel). The four existing deals are provably unchanged (identical hashes) |
| The six screen defects | Five are fixed:<br>• neutral catalogue chips;<br>• formatted documents;<br>• each version's own date;<br>• "Closed by ..." lines;<br>• a neutral brief notice.<br>The sixth stays as it is: every demo deal is in Contracting, because the stage comes only from each deal's documents, and the sealed sets' documents can't be edited. |
| Rejected | • A "Log in" button: there are no accounts.<br>• Hiding the documents list: it answers one of the four 10-second questions. Shortened instead.<br>• Dropping the two coloured card rules: indigo means what we deliver, amber means what needs attention. |

| | |
|---|---|
| Found in my own rehearsal | I misfiled two documents and clicked through a warning, which led to one false closure. Now:<br>• the form pre-selects the document the evidence came from;<br>• warnings state the consequence and put the right action first;<br>• adding a document has no silent default type. |
| Brand | A logo: three pieces forming a D, for promises, contract terms and capabilities |

## 4. Design rules: suggestions must keep these

1. **Visibility, not workflow:** no tasks, assignees, approvals, deadlines, risk scores or AI-suggested impact.
2. **The stage and the findings come from the documents.** A note is a person's word, never proof.
3. **One meaning per colour:** amber means Needs attention; solid green means Closed by documents; outlined grey means Addressed by note; indigo is the brand, never a status.
4. **AI-written text is labelled.** Verified facts and model text never look the same.
5. **Nothing invented:** every word and number on screen comes from stored documents, the catalogue, the deal owner or recorded notes.
6. **The 10-second test** on every screen.

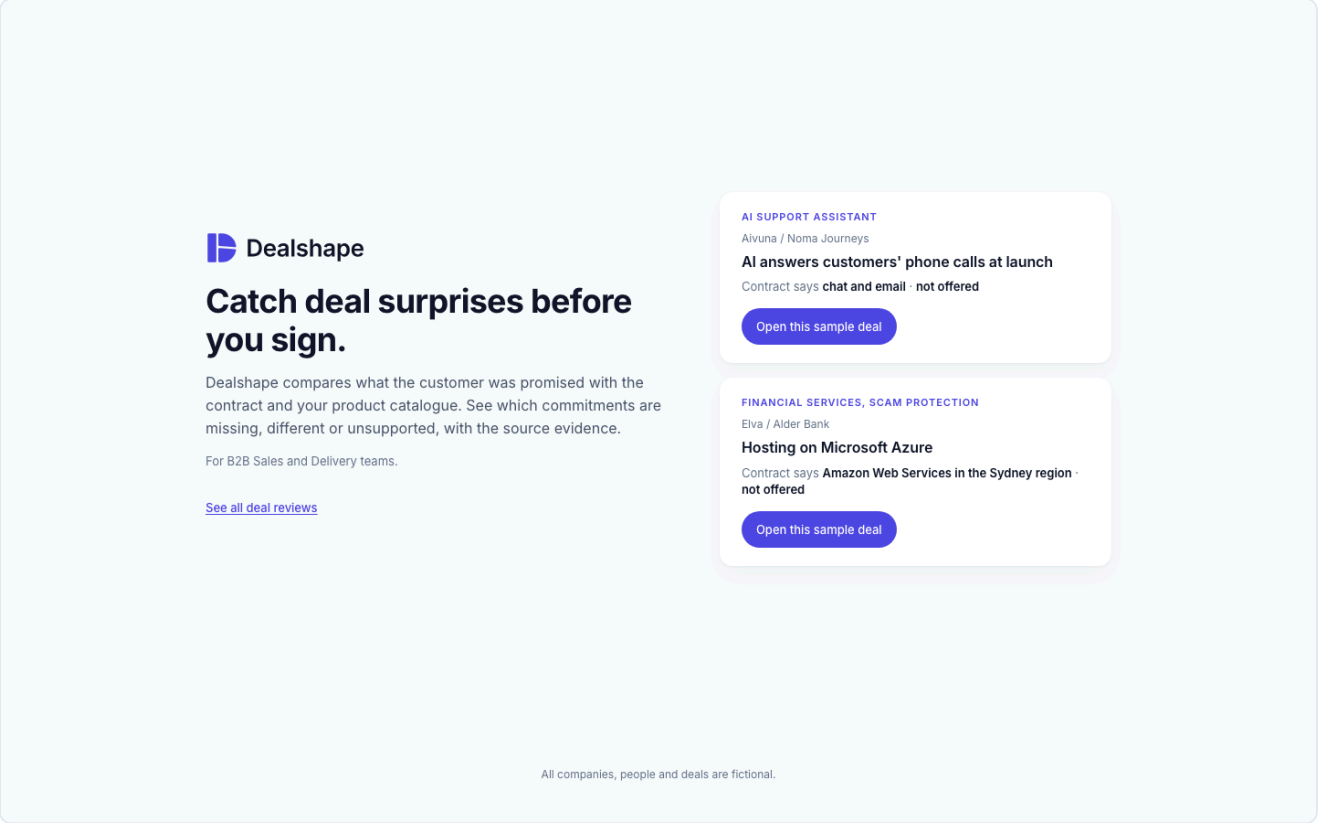
## 5. The two sample deals

| | **AI support assistant** | **Scam protection** |
|---|---|---|
| Vendor / customer | Aivuna / Noma Journeys (a Singapore luxury travel company) | Elva / Alder Bank (an Australian bank) |
| Commitments | • 12 languages: the contract says four;<br>• a launch specialist: no approval, and not in the contract;<br>• phone calls: not offered, and the contract says chat and email. | • Coaching-scam detection: no approval, and not in the contract;<br>• Azure hosting: not offered, and the contract says AWS;<br>• 750,000 payments a day: no approval, and not in the contract. |
| Detection | One model run: 5 findings shown, 0 refused, $0.08. The extra phone finding is legitimate | One finding refused: the model added "with no exceptions", which the documents don't say. Not re-run, to avoid cherry-picking |
| Live rehearsal | Matched the design: 1 needing attention, 1 addressed by note, 1 closed by documents | Matched the design |

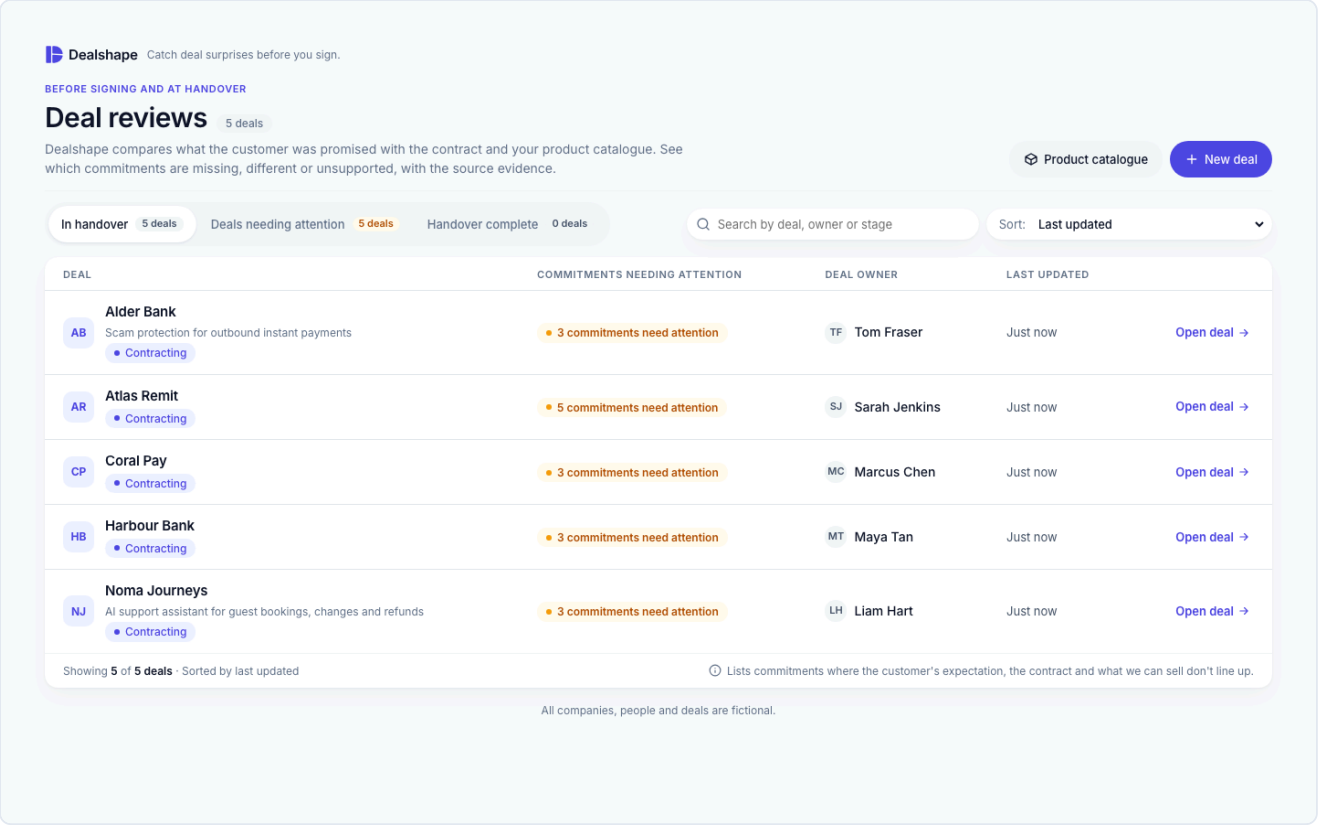
**The demo's strongest moment is partial closure.** A pricing note with the named exception closes "No approval found", while "Not in the contract" stays open. Fixing one side doesn't fix the others, and the screen says so.

## 6. Screens

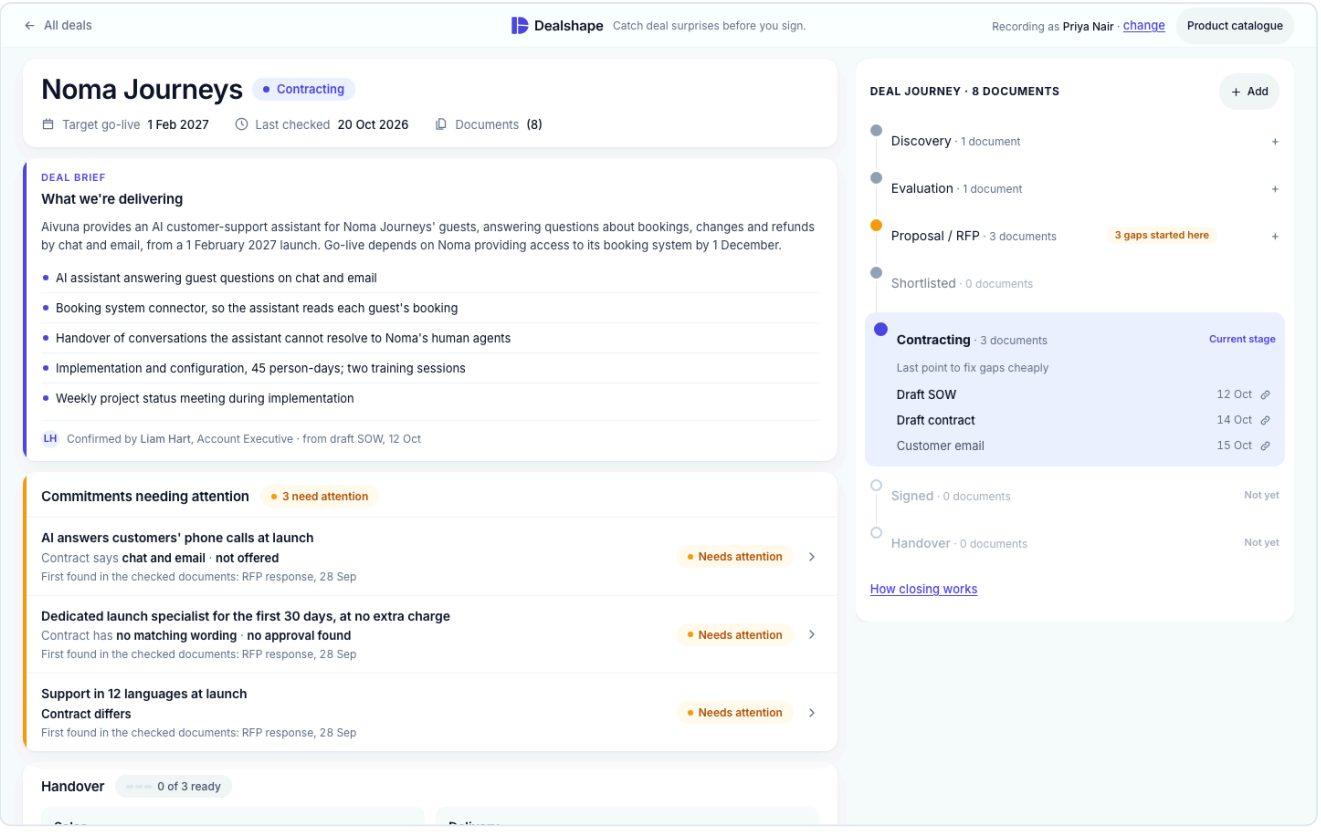
All screenshots are from the working app, at 1440 × 900, light mode, on the fictional demo data.



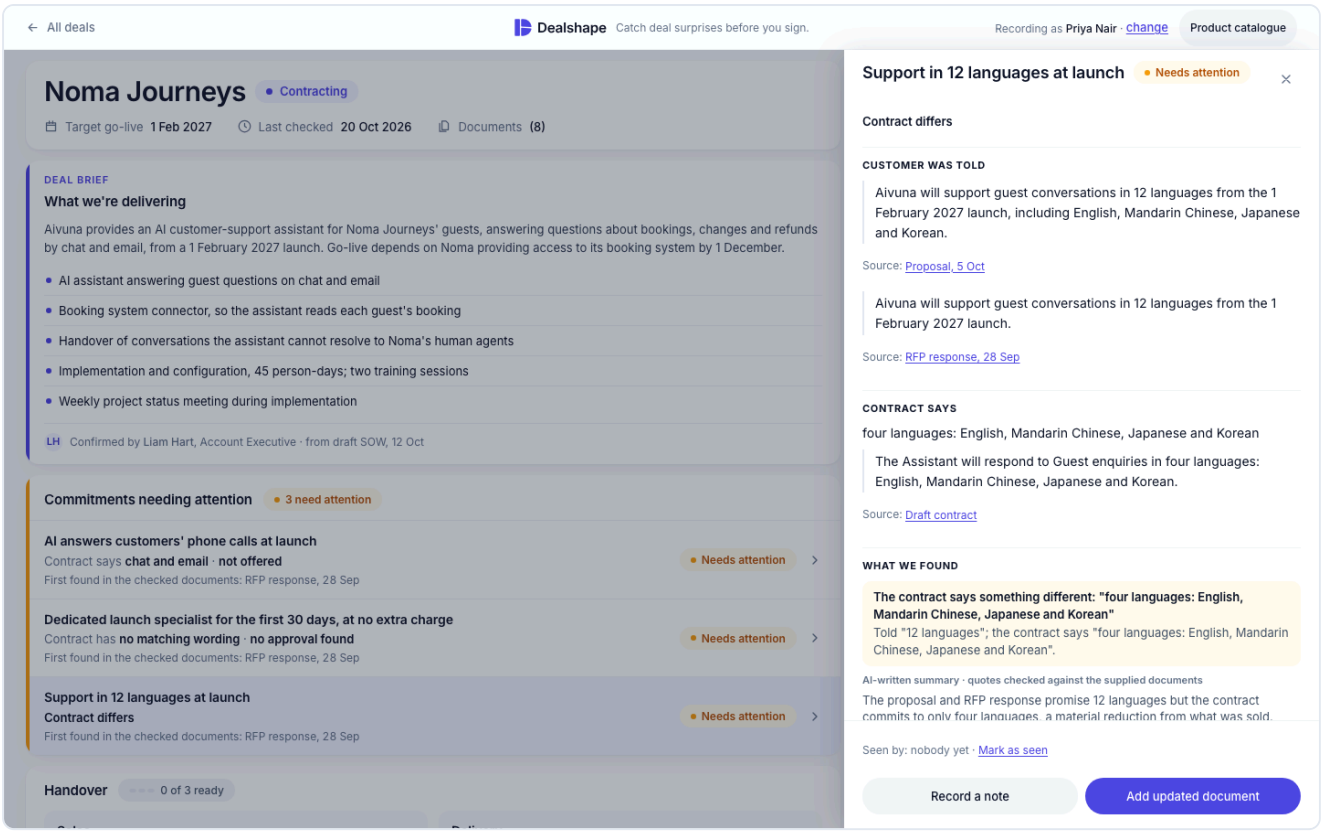

**1 · Landing page.** The tagline, the description, and two sample deals. Each card shows one real mismatch read from that deal's stored data.



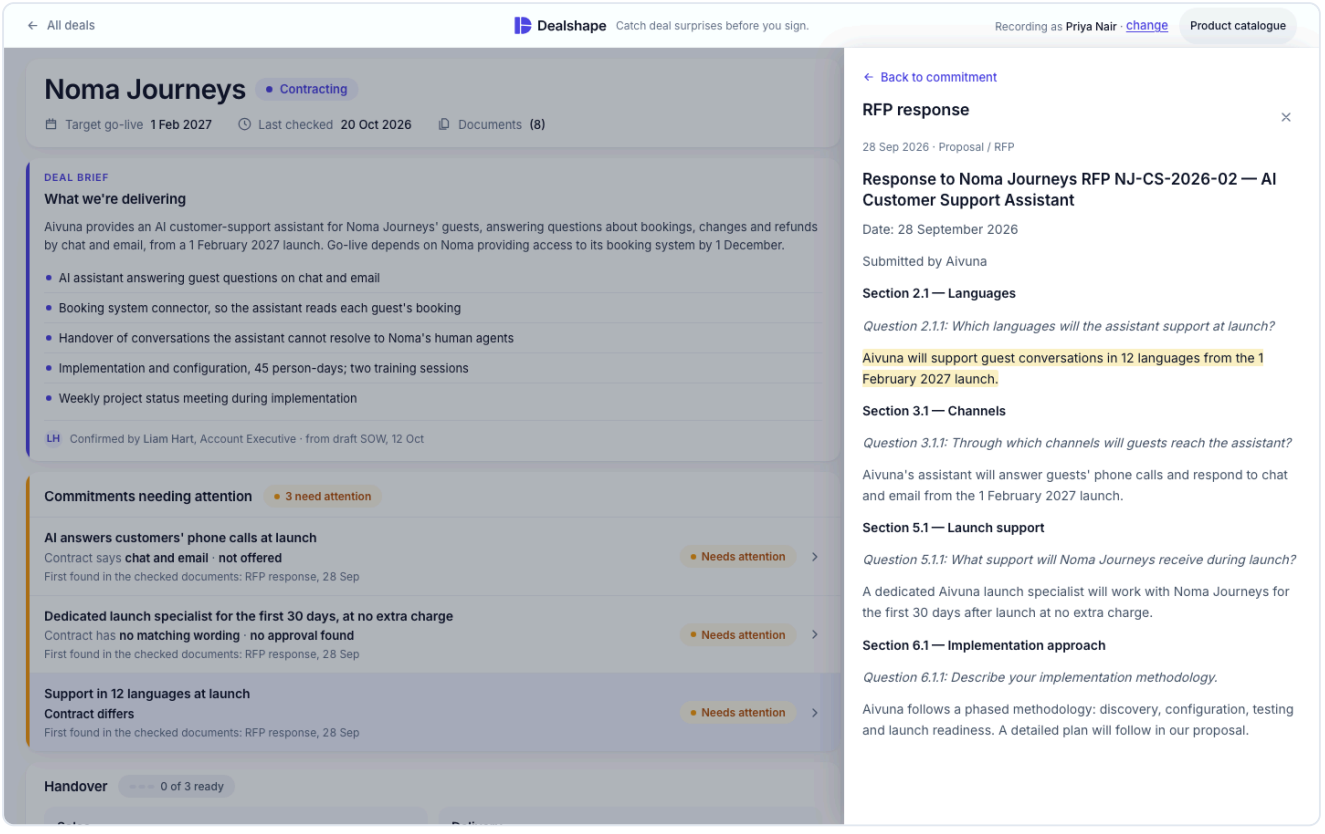

**2 · Deal reviews.** All five deals, each with a scope line under its name. The tabs count deals; the column counts commitments.



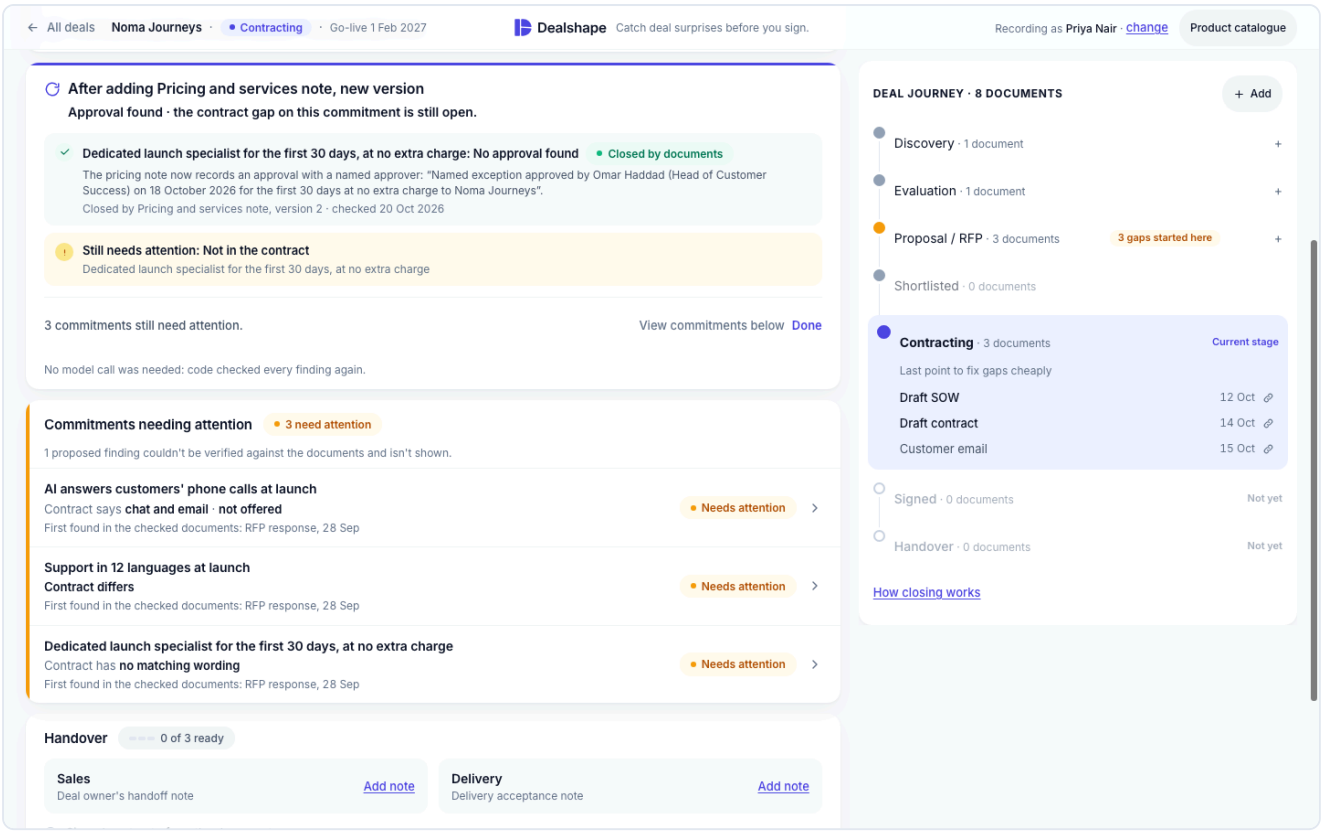

**3 · Noma Journeys deal page.** The header, the deal brief (indigo rule), the commitments (amber rule), each with its one-line mismatch and "First found in the checked documents". The compact deal journey is on the right.



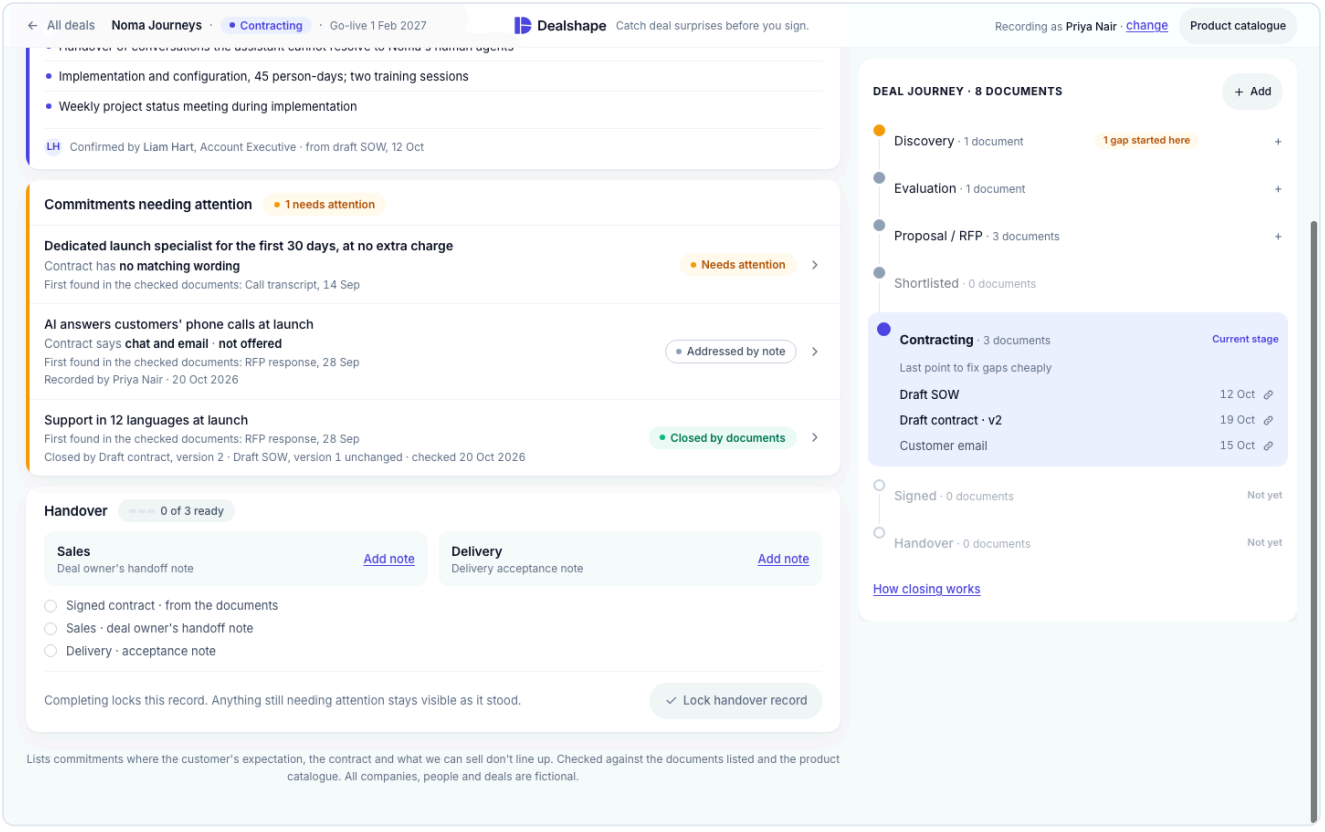

**4 · A commitment in the drawer.** The mismatch first, then the customer's checked quotes, the contract wording, the verified finding, and the labelled AI summary.



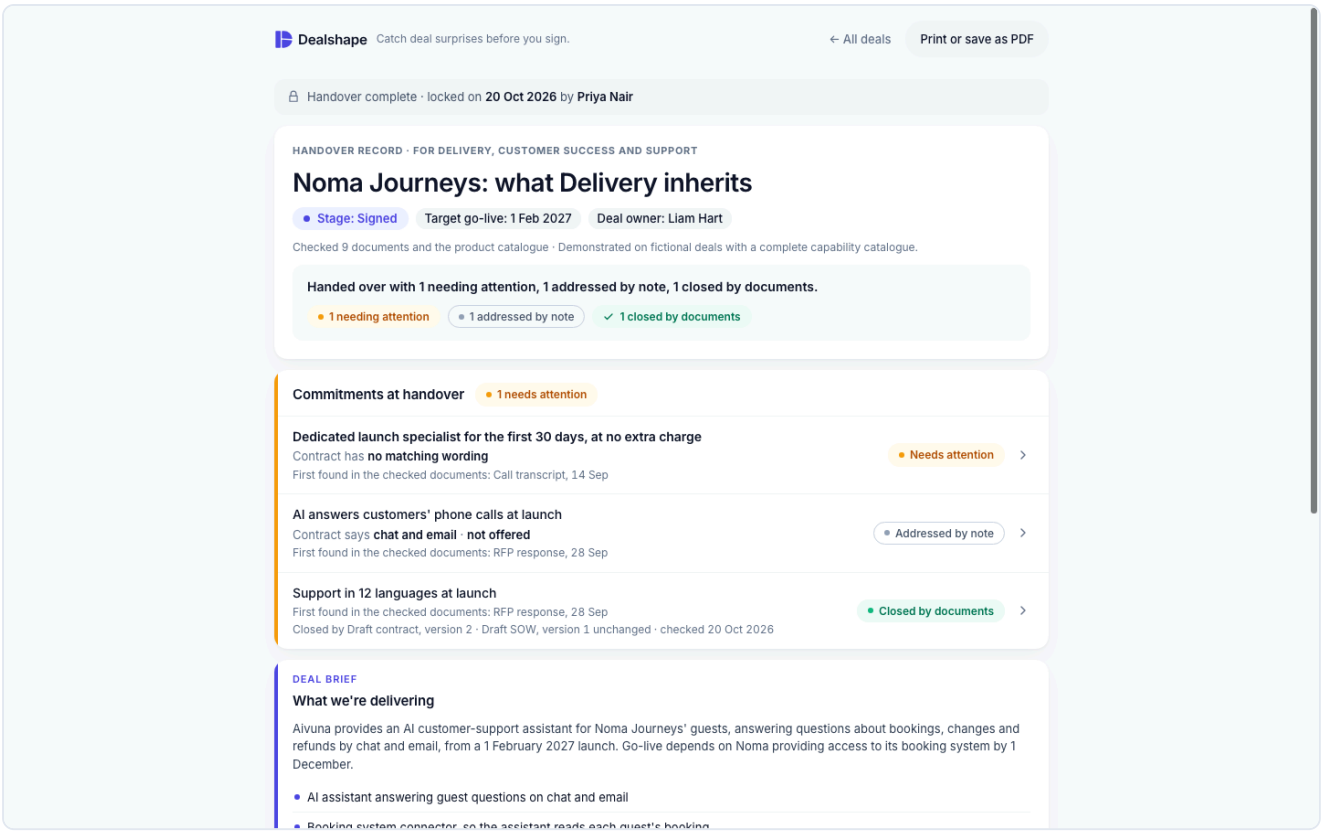

**5 · Source document.** Opened from a quote: formatted text with the quoted sentence highlighted.



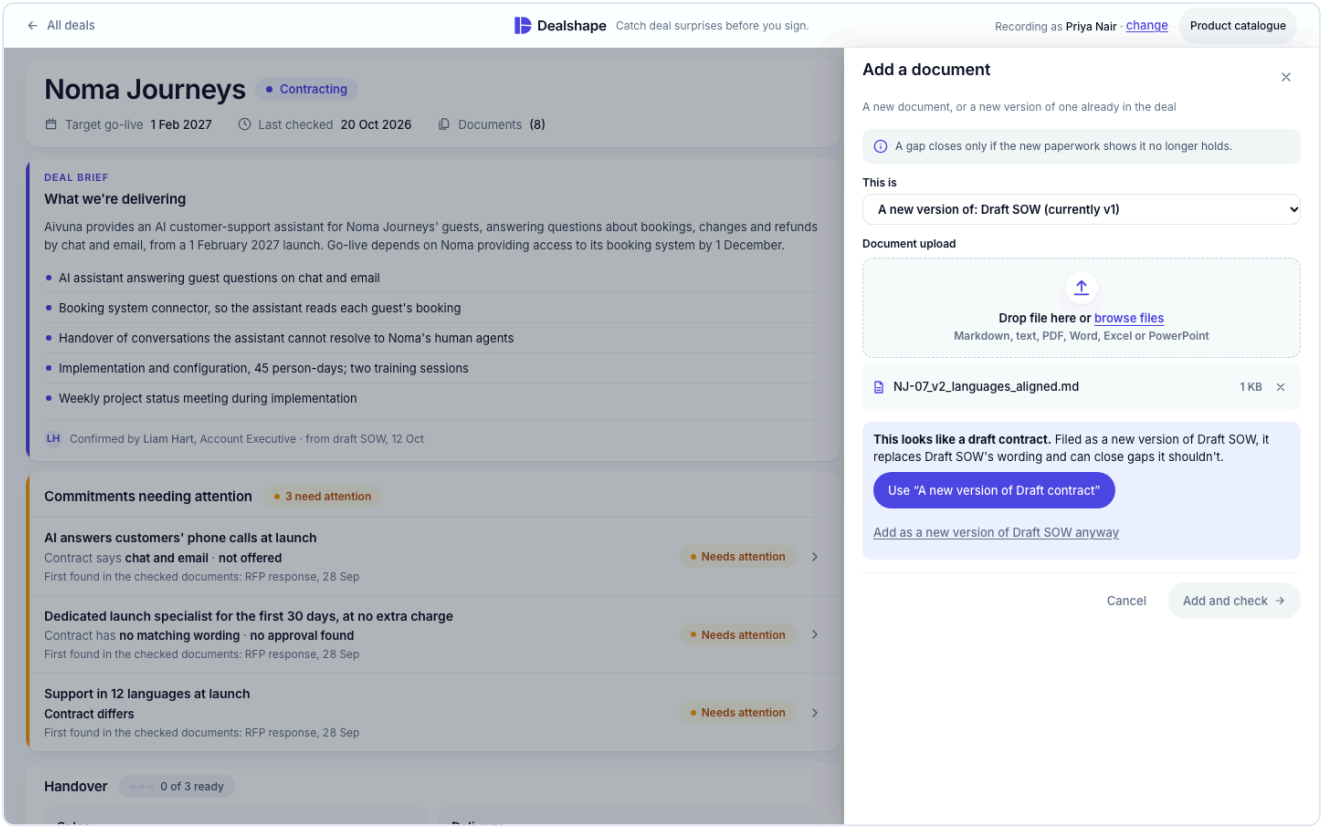

**6 · Partial closure.** After the pricing note with the named exception: the approval gap closed and the contract gap is still open. The result leads; "No model call was needed" sits in the footer.



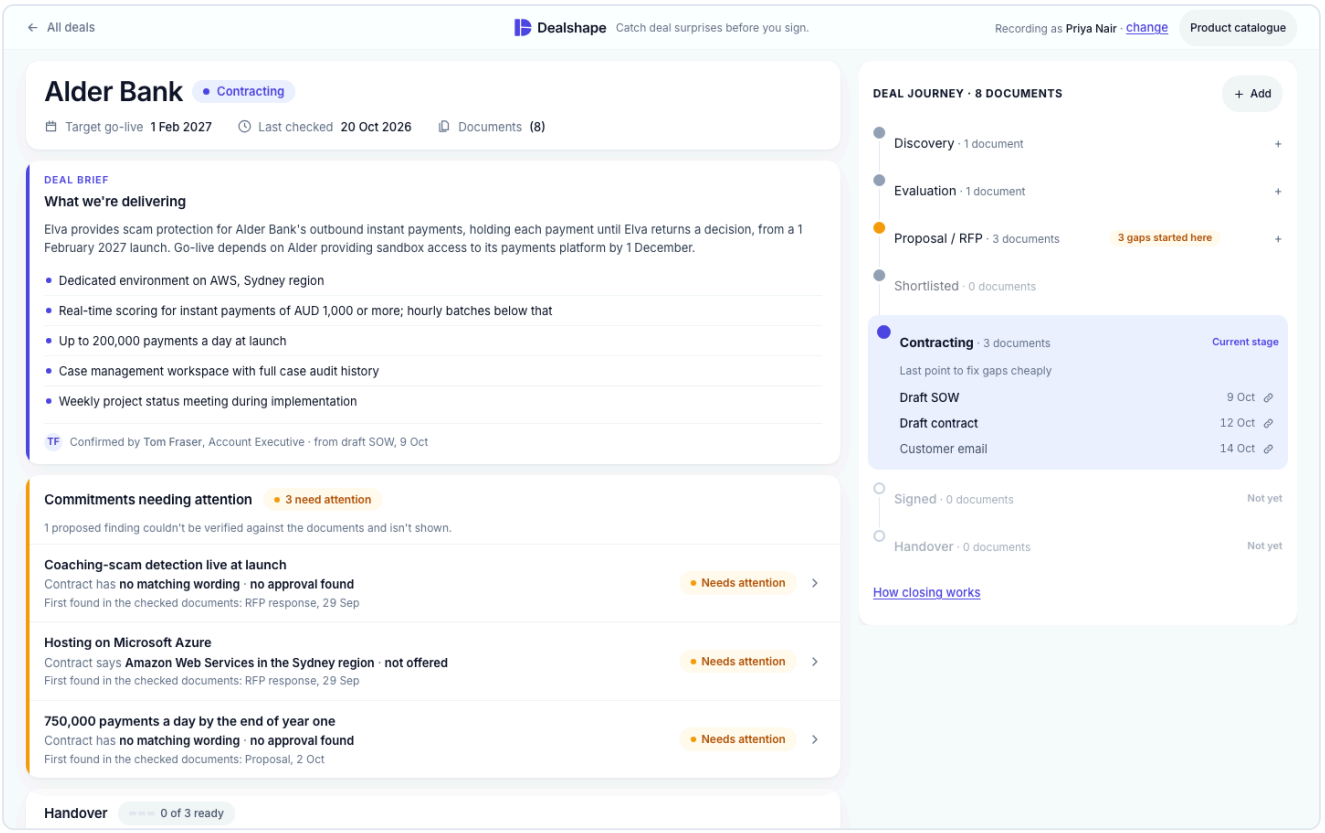

**7 · All three statuses.** Needs attention (amber), Addressed by note (outlined grey), and Closed by documents (solid green, with "Closed by Draft contract, version 2 · Draft SOW, version 1 unchanged · checked 20 Oct 2026"). *The revised-contract step here was applied by script from the cached model reading, because the form wrongly refuses that step when the server has no API key (see section 10).*



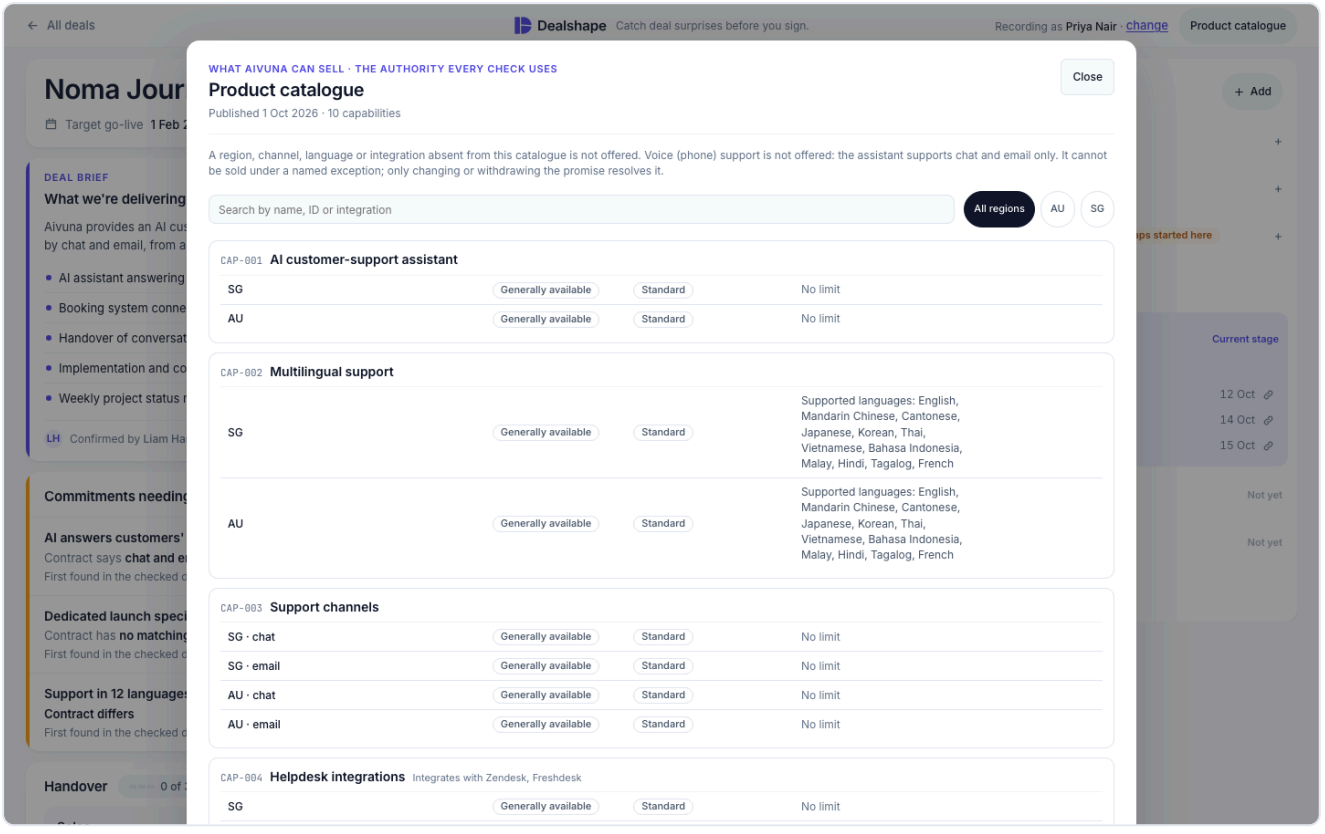

**8 · Locked handover record.** Read-only. The verdict comes first and the open items before the brief.




**9 · Wrong-file notice.** A revised contract picked as a new version of the SOW. The notice states the consequence and leads with the right action; going ahead anyway is a quiet link.




**10 · Alder Bank deal page.** The second sample deal, from another vendor's catalogue. The check-coverage line is visible: one proposed finding couldn't be verified.




**11 · Aivuna's catalogue, opened inside the Noma deal.** Each deal opens its own vendor's catalogue. The rule line states that voice is not offered.

## 7. Evidence so far

| What | Result | Honest reading |
|---|---|---|
| Sealed deal 1 (Coral Pay), v1: rules decide | Rules found 1 of 3; a single model call found 3 of 3 | The rules didn't generalise, so detection was rebuilt |
| Sealed deal 2 (Atlas Remit), v2: model detects, code verifies | 8 of 8, 0 false flags | A small sample. It matched a strong single prompt rather than beating it; its value is that every finding can be checked |
| Both demo deals | Not evaluated | Demonstrations, not measurements |
| Second vendor | One run on the same v2 prompt, which still names the first vendor | Supports "two vendors' catalogues, one pipeline" and nothing broader |
| Reviewers | Head of Growth, COO, Delivery lead, two outside reviews | All friendly contacts. **No unaided test yet** |
| Automated tests | 741 Python, 99 front-end, all passing | They cover behaviour, not usefulness |

## 8. Known limitations (stated in the README)

- **The detection prompt still names the original vendor.** A vendor-neutral prompt would be a new detection version, and the published sealed results describe version 2.
- **The verifier matches words, not meaning.** Reworded promises are where detection is weakest, and a catalogue word in the wrong place can block a true finding.
- **"No matching wording found" means exactly that.** It is not a legal reading.
- **The wrong-file warning reads headings only in Markdown and text files.** For Word and PDF files it uses the file name alone.
- **The catalogue must be complete** for "not offered" to mean anything. That's true here only because the data is fictional.
- **Sales prepares the review,** so the people who made a promise are the ones asked to surface it. That's an incentive problem.
- **No connectors:** documents are uploaded, with a Drive link field. No accounts.

## 9. Out of scope (please don't suggest)

- Workflow: tasks, approvals, assignees, deadlines, notifications.
- Risk scores, or AI-suggested business impact.
- Logins or accounts before the product is validated.
- Anything that lets a person set the stage or close a gap by clicking.

## 10. Issues I've already spotted (go beyond these)

- **Offline demo bug:** with no API key on the server, the revised-contract step is refused, even though its model reading is cached. The cache check uses an empty date, so it reports a miss.
- **"First found" moves** for the launch specialist: "RFP response, 28 Sep" before the updates, "Call transcript, 14 Sep" after. A later reading quoted the earlier call. That's correct by its own rule, but it may confuse a viewer.
- **Every demo deal is in Contracting,** so the stage column says little.
- **No unaided user test yet.**